Water Cycle: Class Notes (Page 1)

The water cycle is the continuous movement of water on, above and below the surface of the Earth.

Step 1, Evaporation: the Sun heats water in oceans, rivers and lakes, and it turns into water vapour.

Step 2, Condensation: the water vapour rises, cools down and forms tiny droplets, which make clouds.

Step 3, Precipitation: when the droplets become heavy they fall as rain, snow or hail.

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Step 4, Collection: rain water collects in rivers, lakes, oceans and under the ground as groundwater.

Plants also give out water vapour from their leaves. This is called transpiration.

About 97 percent of the water on Earth is salt water in the oceans. Only about 3 percent is fresh water.

Teacher's note: learn the four steps in the correct order for the test on Monday.